

Purpose: To help us feel the Savior’s love and increase our love for Him and our gratitude for His atoning sacrifice.

1. Jesus is betrayed, arrested, and accused of blasphemy; Peter denies Jesus three times.

- Read, ponder and discuss [Matthew 26:47-75](#); [Mark 14:43-72](#); [Luke 22:47-71](#); and [John 18:1-27](#).
- John 18:10. “Then Simon Peter having a sword drew it, and smote the high priest’s servant, and cut off his right ear.”
- Luke 22:51-53. “And Jesus ... touched his ear, and healed him.”
- Matt. 26:53-54. “Thinkest thou that I cannot now pray to my Father and he shall ... give me more than twelve legions of angels? But how then shall the scriptures be fulfilled ... ?”

†1. The Savior Could Have Summoned Legions of Angels †2. Gerald N. Lund

Why did Jesus allow himself to be taken?

- Mark 14:60-64. “Art thou the Christ ...? And Jesus said, I am”.

†3. The Charge of Blasphemy

- Matt. 26:56-58. His disciples “forsook him, and fled... But Peter followed him afar off ... to see the end.”
- Matt. 26:69-75. Peter “began to curse and to swear, saying, I know not the man. And immediately the cock crew.”

†4. Elder Gordon B. Hinckley

2. Jesus is sentenced to be crucified.

- Read, ponder and discuss [Matthew 27:1-26](#); [Mark 15:1-15](#); [Luke 23:1-25](#); and [John 18:28—19:16](#).
- Luke 23:6-8. Herod “was exceeding glad ... and he hoped to have seen some miracle done by him.”
- Compare Luke 23:9 with [Isaiah 53:7](#). “He was oppressed, and he was afflicted, yet he opened not his mouth”.
- Luke 23:10-11. “And Herod with his men of war set him at nought, and mocked him ... and sent him again to Pilate.”
- Luke 23:13-17 and 4. “I, having examined him before you, have found no fault in this man”.

How might we, like Pilate, sometimes try to avoid responsibility for difficult decisions?

- John 18:37. Pilate asked, “Art thou a king then? Jesus answered, ... To this end was I born”.

In what ways is Jesus a king? (See [Psalm 24:10](#); [Isaiah 44:6](#); [Revelation 11:15](#); [15:3](#); [2 Nephi 10:14](#).)

What does it mean that his “kingdom is not of this world”? (See John 18:36.)

3. Jesus is scourged and crucified.

- Read, ponder and discuss [Matthew 27:27-66](#); [Mark 15:16-39](#); [Luke 22:26-56](#); and [John 19:17-42](#).
- Matthew 27:27-44; Luke 23:34-39. “And when they had plaited a crown of thorns, they ... mocked him”.

Why did Jesus allow the people to persecute him? (See [1 Nephi 19:9](#).)

Jesus made seven statements while He was on the cross.

1. Luke 23:34. “Father, forgive them; for they know not what they do.” (Footnote 34c, JST Luke 23:35 ... the soldiers)

How are we blessed when we follow Jesus’s example?

2. Luke 23:43. To the repentant thief: “Verily I say unto thee, To day thou shalt be with me in paradise.”

3. John 19:26-27. To his mother, Mary: “Woman, behold thy son!” To John: “Behold thy mother!”

Whose needs did Jesus think of during His pain? What can we learn from His example?

4. Matthew 27:46; Mark 15:34. “My God, my God, why hast thou forsaken me?” †5. Elder Jeffrey R. Holland

Why is it important to know that the Savior can also bear our loneliness, grief, and fear?

5. John 19:28. “I thirst.”

“Despite all that Jesus suffered, this was his only mention of physical discomfort.” (LM)

6. John 19:30. “It is finished.” JST: “Father, it is finished, thy will is done” (See Matthew 27:50, footnote 50a).

Why did the Savior have to die to accomplish Heavenly Father’s will?

(See [2 Nephi 9:5](#) and [3 Nephi 27:13-16](#).) †6. President Spencer W. Kimball

7. Luke 23:46. “Father, into thy hands I commend my spirit.”

Next Week: L27 “He Is Not Here, for He Is Risen”; See L27: [Class Member Study Guide](#).

(You can download a free LDS Institute manual at: [New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212](#).) † •

NTL26 Quotes

†1. **The Savior Could Have Summoned Legions of Angels:** “Taken literally, ‘twelve legions of angels’ would have been between 36,000 and 72,000 angels. His cursing of a fig tree a few days before had shown that He could destroy with a word (see Matthew 21:19-20). He had power to defend Himself but chose not to use it at this time. The Book of Mormon prophet Jacob taught his people of the Lord’s power saying, ‘He can pierce you, and with one glance of his eye he can smite you to the dust!’ (Jacob 2:15).” (*New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212*, “[Chapter 9: Matthew 26](#),” 2014. **Scroll down to:** “Matthew 26:51-54. The Savior Could Have Summoned Legions of Angels”.)

†2. **Gerald N. Lund:** “Imagine the Being whose power, whose light, whose glory holds the universe in order, the Being who speaks and solar systems, galaxies, and stars come into existence—standing before wicked men and being judged by them as being of no worth or value!
“When we think of what he could have done to these men who took him to judgment, we have a new and different sense of his condescension. When Judas led the soldiers and the high priests to the Garden of Gethsemane and betrayed him with a kiss, Jesus could have spoken a single word and leveled the entire city of Jerusalem. When the servant of the high priest stepped forward and slapped his face, Jesus could have lifted a finger and sent that man back to his original elements. When another man stepped forward and spit in his face, Jesus had only to blink and our entire solar system could have been annihilated. But he stood there, he endured, he suffered, he condescended” (Cited in *New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212*, “[Chapter 9: Matthew 26](#),” 2014. **Scroll down to:** “Matthew 26:51-54. The Savior Could Have Summoned Legions of Angels” and read **Gerald N. Lund**.)

†3. **The Charge of Blasphemy:** The “Savior’s claim to divine power and authority would have been blasphemy only if it had been untrue... [S]ince blasphemy was a Jewish matter and of no concern to the Romans, the Jewish leaders changed the charge to sedition when they took Jesus to Pilate.” (Cited in *N.T.S.M.*, “[Chapter 9: Matthew 26](#),” 2014. **Scroll down to:** “Matthew 26:61-66. The Charge of Blasphemy”)

†4. **President Gordon B. Hinckley:** “My heart goes out to Peter. So many of us are so much like him. We pledge our loyalty; we affirm our determination to be of good courage; we declare, sometimes even publicly, that come what may we will do the right thing, that we will stand for the right cause, that we will be true to ourselves and to others.

“Then the pressures begin to build. Sometimes these are social pressures. Sometimes they are personal

appetites. Sometimes they are false ambitions. There is a weakening of the will. There is a softening of discipline. There is capitulation. And then there is remorse, followed by self-accusation and bitter tears of regret...

“... If there be those throughout the Church who by word or act have denied the faith, **I pray that you may draw comfort and resolution from the example of Peter, who, though he had walked daily with Jesus, in an hour of extremity momentarily denied the Lord and also the testimony which he carried in his own heart. But he rose above this and became a mighty defender and a powerful advocate.** So, too, there is a way for any person to turn about and add his or her strength and faith to the strength and faith of others in building the kingdom of God”. (“[And Peter Went Out and Wept Bitterly](#),” *Ensign*, Mar. 1995, 2–4, 6. Cited in the *Lesson Manual*.)

†5. **Elder Jeffrey R. Holland:** “Because he must ultimately tread this winepress of redemption unaided, can he endure the darkest moment of them all, the shock of the greatest pain? This comes not with thorns and with nails, but with the terror of feeling utterly alone: ... ‘My God, My God, why hast thou forsaken me?’ (Mark 15:34). Can he bear all of our sins and our fear and loneliness too? He did and he does and he will” (“[He Loved Them unto the End](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1989, 26).

†6. **President Spencer W. Kimball:** “He needed to die, that he might open the graves of all men as his own tomb was opened. Without the deep darkness of the crucifixion hour, there could have been no spring of coming from the grave” (“[Why Call Me Lord, Lord, and Do Not the Things Which I Say?](#)” *Ensign*, May 1975, 4).

Recommended Reading:

1. President Dieter F. Uchtdorf, “[The Gift of Grace](#),” *Ensign*, May 2015, 107-110.
2. Brad Wilcox, “[His Grace Is Sufficient](#),” *Ensign*, September 2013.
3. *New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212*, “[Chapter 9: Matthew 26](#),” 2014. **Scroll down to:** “Matthew 26:47-50. The Betrayal of the Savior”.
4. *New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212*, “[Chapter 10: Matthew 27-28](#),” 2014.
5. [NT26 Enrichment.pdf](#) contains more quotes and links to articles, blogs, and speeches.

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